MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL BLOCKS

PCEP-30-02: Certified Entry-Level Python Programmer

A complete exam course: four blocks of teaching, three review modules and four practice papers.

PART Introduction COURSE 6h 27m QUESTIONS 314 worked

admin@sthithapragna.com

Almost every PCEP question is code and a question: **what happens?** This course teaches you to answer it by tracing, accurately, in your head.

The exam

ITEM	DETAIL
Questions and time	30 questions in 40 minutes, plus a 5 minute NDA and tutorial
Pass mark	70%, which is 21 out of 30
Question types	single and multiple select, drag and drop, gap fill, code insertion
Delivery	TestNow: online, with a proctor; no notes of any kind
Validity and cost	5 years; from 69 US dollars; retake after 7 days

Check the version: PCEP-30-03 is coming

- **PCEP-30-02** is the active exam, and the one this course teaches.
- **PCEP-30-03** is listed as in development. Its target was Q3 2026, which has passed without a release.
- Check the version code on your voucher. If 30-03 is live, compare its syllabus with this course.
- The update does not affect the 5-year validity of certificates already earned.

The four blocks, weighted as the exam weights them

PART	EXAM WEIGHT	MODULES	MINUTES
Block 1: Fundamentals	18%	1 to 5	68
Block 2: Control flow	29%	6 to 10	63
Block 3: Data collections	25%	11 to 15	60
Block 4: Functions and exceptions	28%	16 to 21	67
Review	all blocks	22 to 24	32
Practice papers	7 / 8 / 7 / 8 questions	25 to 28	92

Modules 1 to 14

MODULE	TITLE	LENGTH
01	How Python runs your code	13 min
02	Literals, variables and numeral systems	13 min
03	Arithmetic operators and precedence	15 min
04	Comparison, Boolean and bitwise operators	15 min
05	Console input, output and type casting	12 min
06	Making decisions: if, elif and else	12 min
07	while loops	12 min
08	for loops and range()	13 min
09	Nested loops, break, continue and else	13 min
10	Loop patterns the exam loves	13 min
11	Lists I: indexing, slicing and methods	13 min
12	Lists II: references, copies and comprehensions	13 min
13	Tuples	9 min
14	Dictionaries	11 min

Modules 15 to 28

MODULE	TITLE	LENGTH
15	Strings	13 min
16	Functions I: def, return and None	11 min
17	Functions II: passing arguments	12 min
18	Scope and the global keyword	11 min
19	Recursion and generators	11 min
20	The exception hierarchy	8 min
21	Handling exceptions	13 min
22	Spot the error	14 min
23	Confusion pairs	9 min
24	Exam mechanics and question formats	10 min
25	Practice paper 1	23 min
26	Practice paper 2	23 min
27	Practice paper 3	24 min
28	Practice paper 4: final rehearsal	23 min

Original questions, official sources, real Python

- A bank of 481 practice questions was analysed for **topics only**. No question was reused.
- Facts come from docs.python.org, the Python Institute's syllabus and policies, and Python Essentials 1.
- **Every code example was run on Python 3.12 and Python 3.14** before it was written into a slide.
- Where the two versions differ, the slide says so, and gives the exam's answer.

Where Python 3.14 and the exam differ

CHANGE	PYTHON 3.14	ANSWER ON THE EXAM
`except A, B:` without brackets	legal (PEP 758)	use brackets: except (A, B):
`return` inside `finally`	SyntaxWarning (PEP 765)	behaviour is unchanged
several error messages	reworded	answer by the exception's name
soft keywords `match`, `case`, `_`, `type`	legal names	there are still 35 keywords

Where study material can mislead you

- Logical **not** sits below every comparison, not beside unary minus. Module 4.
- Only one except branch ever runs for an exception. Module 21.
- The exam treats a full string slice as a copy; CPython may not. Module 15.
- The certificate lasts 5 years. Some websites wrongly say it never expires.

A study route

01

Learn

Modules 1 to 21 in order. Commit to every worked question before the answer.

02

Review

Modules 22 to 24: errors, look-alikes, and the exam itself.

03

Practise

Papers 1 to 3, without paper. Revisit the block your misses point to.

04

Rehearse

Paper 4 under exam conditions, a few days before you sit.

ONE HABIT

Run the code yourself as you go: Python, IDLE, or the free Edube sandbox. Seeing it run fixes the rule.

Module 1 starts with the idea that decides more PCEP answers than any other: Python checks the whole file before it runs a single line.